

Workplace Harassment in Pakistan

A safe starting point

The Protection against Harassment of Women at the Workplace Act, 2010 applies across Pakistan. The 2022 amendment broadened protections and clarified complaint mechanisms. This guide helps preserve facts; it is not legal advice.

- Record dates, locations, words, witnesses, and the impact of each incident.
- Keep appointment records, messages, emails, and relevant workplace policies.
- Do not retaliate or delete evidence; protect your personal safety first.

Know the reporting structure

Inquiry committee and ombudsperson

An organisation should constitute an inquiry committee under the Act. A complainant may use the internal process or approach the Federal Ombudsperson for Protection against Harassment (FOSPAH), subject to the applicable procedure.

- Ask for the committee contact and code of conduct in writing.
- Submit a dated complaint with a clear chronology and requested protection.
- Keep a copy and note the date and method of delivery.

Build a careful record

Evidence that can help

Screenshots, original emails, call logs, attendance records, CCTV requests, and witness names may help establish what happened. Preserve originals and avoid editing files.

- Export messages with dates and account identifiers where possible.
- Store a backup outside a work device, while respecting confidentiality.
- Note any retaliation, transfer, exclusion, or threats after reporting.

During an inquiry

Procedural fairness

The Act provides a process for notice, response, inquiry, findings, and penalties. The exact route and timelines depend on the forum and facts.

- Read any notice carefully and meet its response deadline.
- Ask for reasonable safety or non-contact measures if needed.
- Do not publish allegations online; use the authorised process.

Official sources and next steps

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- Pakistan Code, Protection against Harassment of Women at the Workplace Act, 2010:
<https://pakistancode.gov.pk/pdf/files/administratorc22e81f4add9ea3dc023086953ca2b4f.pdf>
- FOSPAH: <https://www.fospah.gov.pk/>

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